Advanced Punctuation (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Worked Example: Explain the difference between how a dash and a pair of brackets are used to add extra information, using one example sentence for each.

Answer: Both add extra, removable information. A dash — like this — feels more dramatic/informal, e.g. 'The cake — my favourite — was gone.' Brackets feel more formal/neutral, e.g. 'The cake (my favourite) was gone.'

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Join these two sentences with a semicolon: 'The wind dropped. The sea grew calm.'
2. Add a colon to introduce the list: 'Pack these items a jumper a hat and gloves.'
3. Which sentence correctly punctuates direct speech? A) Sam said, I am tired. B) Sam said, "I am tired." C) Sam said "I am tired" D) "Sam said I am tired." E) Sam said: I am tired.
4. Add brackets to insert this extra detail: 'My teacher who studied in France speaks fluent French.'
5. Underline the correct use of a dash in: 'The journey — though long — was enjoyable.'
6. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'Is dinner ready asked Mia'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use a colon to introduce a list? A) He packed: trainers, shorts and a towel. B) He packed trainers: shorts and a towel. C) He needed three things: focus, time and energy. D) He needed: three things. E) The winners were: Jo, Alex and Sam.
8. Which punctuation mark correctly joins these two related sentences: 'She was thrilled ___ she had won first prize.'? A) comma B) colon C) semicolon D) dash E) full stop with no change
9. Add speech marks to: Wait for me! called Noah.
10. Explain what a colon does before a list, using the sentence: 'Bring the following: a book, a pen and a ruler.'
11. Which sentence correctly uses a semicolon to join two related main clauses? A) The power failed; because of the lightning. B) The power failed, the lightning was fierce. C) The power failed; the lightning was fierce. D) The power failed: the lightning was fierce. E) The power failed the lightning was fierce.
12. Punctuate this sentence with brackets around the extra information: 'The library which opens at ten is free to join.'
13. Write a short sentence of direct speech with the reporting clause BEFORE the speech, punctuated correctly.
14. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly punctuate a dash used to add an afterthought? A) The race was close — until the last lap. B) The race was close, until the last lap —. C) The race was close — until the last lap. D) The — race was close until the last lap. E) The match ended in a tie — a fair result.
15. Explain why 'She said "finally"' is missing a capital letter and a full stop, and correct it.

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. Join these two related sentences using a semicolon: 'The test was tricky. Most students still did well.'
2. Add a colon to this sentence: 'There was only one reason he was smiling he had passed.'
3. Which sentence correctly punctuates a piece of direct speech split by a reporting clause? A) "I believe," said Omar, "we can win." B) "I believe" said Omar "we can win." C) "I believe, said Omar, we can win." D) I believe, said Omar, "we can win." E) "I believe said Omar we can win."

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4. Insert dashes to add this extra comment: 'The weather report and it is usually accurate predicted sunshine.'

5. Explain the difference between using a comma and using a semicolon to join two main clauses, with an example of each.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use brackets for extra (removable) information? A) The tower (built in 1890) still stands. B) The tower built in 1890 (still stands.) C) The recipe (serves six) takes two hours. D) (The recipe serves six) takes two hours. E) Our coach (Mrs Lane) is very encouraging.

7. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'I cannot believe it he gasped we actually won'

8. Which punctuation mark best replaces the gap: 'The decision was final ___ the appeal was rejected.'? A) comma B) colon C) apostrophe D) exclamation mark E) hyphen

9. Explain when you would choose a dash rather than a colon to introduce extra information, giving one example of each.

10. Rewrite this sentence using a semicolon instead of 'and': 'The choir practised daily, and they deserved to win.'

11. Which sentence correctly punctuates a question within direct speech? A) He asked, "Are we lost?" B) He asked "Are we lost"? C) He asked, "Are we lost"? D) He asked: "Are we lost?" E) He asked, Are we lost?

12. Add a colon to introduce an explanation in: 'There was a simple reason for the delay the train broke down.'

13. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly use a semicolon rather than a comma to join two independent clauses? A) He likes football; she prefers tennis. B) He likes football, she prefers tennis. C) It was late; we still finished the walk. D) It was late, we still finished the walk. E) The shop opened late; customers waited outside.

14. Write one sentence that correctly uses a colon to introduce a single dramatic statement (not a list).

15. Explain why brackets, dashes and commas can all sometimes be used to mark off the same piece of extra information, giving one sentence punctuated three different ways.

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. Punctuate this direct speech exchange correctly, including both speakers: Are you ready asked Lily I just need one more minute replied Theo

2. Explain the difference between how a semicolon and a colon each connect two parts of a sentence, giving one original example of each.

3. Which sentence correctly uses a colon before a list that is introduced by a complete independent clause? A) My favourite subjects are: maths, art and science. B) I enjoy: maths, art and science. C) My favourite subjects are these: maths, art and science. D) Subjects I enjoy maths, art and science. E) I enjoy maths: art and science.

4. Correct this sentence, which has one missing colon and one misplaced comma: 'The challenge needs just one thing, courage and plenty of it.'

5. Select ALL that apply. Which of the following correctly use a semicolon to join two closely related independent clauses? A) The road was icy; drivers slowed down. B) The road was icy, drivers slowed down. C) Some pupils chose chess; others chose debate. D) Some pupils chose chess, others chose debate. E) It snowed heavily; the lesson still went ahead.

6. Write a sentence containing direct speech interrupted by a reporting clause, where the speech continues as a NEW sentence after the reporting clause. Punctuate it fully and correctly.

7. Which sentence below correctly uses a pair of dashes to mark off a strongly emphasised interruption? A) The outcome — surprisingly was unexpected. B) The outcome surprisingly — was unexpected. C) The outcome — surprisingly — was unexpected. D) The — outcome surprisingly was unexpected —. E) The outcome surprisingly was — unexpected.

8. Explain why 'The box contained something unexpected: old photographs.' uses a colon rather than a semicolon, referring to the rule about what a colon introduces.

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9. Correct this passage, which has two punctuation errors (one missing colon, one missing closing speech mark): "I have solved the puzzle, she announced. It was hidden in plain sight the whole time.

10. Which sentence correctly combines a colon AND a semicolon in the same sentence? A) She had one aim: to finish; nothing else mattered. B) She had one aim to finish: nothing else mattered; C) She had one aim; to finish: nothing else mattered. D) She had one aim to finish, nothing else mattered; E) She had one aim: to finish, nothing else mattered.

11. Explain the difference in formality between using a dash and using brackets for the same piece of extra information, giving one example sentence punctuated both ways.

12. Rewrite this sentence, replacing the comma splice with either a semicolon or a full stop and capital letter: 'The whistle blew, every player stopped instantly.'

13. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly punctuate direct speech that ends with the reporting clause AFTER a question? A) "Why is it so quiet?" asked Finn. B) "Why is it so quiet" asked Finn? C) "Why is it so quiet," asked Finn? D) "Why is it so quiet?", asked Finn. E) "Why is it so quiet?" Finn asked.

14. Write one sentence that uses BOTH a pair of brackets for extra information AND a colon to introduce a short list.

15. Explain why the sentence 'She shouted, "Stop" and then ran off.' is missing punctuation after 'Stop', and correct it fully.

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